

DR. FELIX OTTO

Faculty of Economics and Social Sciences , University of Tübingen
Wilhelmstraße 124, 72074 Tübingen, Germany

felix.otto@uni-tuebingen.de · felix-otto.github.io · ORCID: 0000-0002-7576-289X

Last updated: September 2026

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Sports economics, behavioral economics, applied econometrics, data science

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

- 2022–present **Postdoctoral Researcher in Sports Economics**
Department of Sport Economics, Sport Management and Media Research,
Institute of Sports Science, University of Tübingen
- 2017–2022 **Research Assistant**
Department of Sport Economics, Sport Management and Media Research,
Institute of Sports Science, University of Tübingen

EDUCATION

- 2022 **Dr. rer. soc.**, University of Tübingen (summa cum laude)
Thesis: *How trust in fairness and national identity affect the behavior of spectators and judges in sports*
Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Tim Pawlowski
- 2013–2017 **M.Sc. Sport Management**, German Sport University Cologne
Semester abroad (2015): Victoria University, Melbourne, Australia
- 2010–2013 **B.A. Sport Management**, University of Potsdam

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-reviewed journal articles

Political relations and sports: Exploring the demand for relocated soccer games

with Georgios Nalbantis and Tim Pawlowski. *European Sport Management Quarterly*, 24(1), 159–177, 2024. [DOI]

Nationalistic bias among international experts: Evidence from professional ski jumping

with Alex Krumer and Tim Pawlowski. *Scandinavian Journal of Economics*, 124(1), 278–300, 2022. [DOI]

Trust in fairness, doping, and the demand for sports: A study on international track and field events

with Tim Pawlowski and Sonja Utz. *European Sport Management Quarterly*, 21(5), 731–747, 2021. [DOI]

“Germany crashes out of World Cup”: A mixed-method study on the effects of crisis communication on Facebook

with Tim Pawlowski and Sonja Utz. *Journal of Sport Management*, 35(1), 44–54, 2021. [DOI]

Animation intensity of sponsorship signage: The impact on sport viewers' attention and viewer confusion

with Christopher Rumpf. *Sport, Business and Management: An International Journal*, 8(2), 177–194, 2018. [DOI]

Books

Integrität im Sport: Forschungsstand zur Prävention von integritätsgefährdenden Phänomenen

with Christian Deutscher, Finn Spilker, and Tim Pawlowski. Springer VS (essentials), 2026. [DOI]

WORKING PAPERS

Varying reference-point salience

with Alex Krumer and Tim Pawlowski. [arXiv]

Trimming of extreme votes and favoritism: Evidence from the field

with Alex Krumer and Tim Pawlowski. [arXiv]

Work in progress (Selection)

Gender and nationalistic bias

with Alex Krumer and Tim Pawlowski

Performance-enhancing drugs in economic competitions

with Svenja Toepesch, Christian Deutscher, and Tim Pawlowski

GRANTS AND FUNDING

2024–2025 **Integrity in Sports** (“Integrität im Sport”), Federal Institute for Sports Science (BISp), project PR020240400083
PIs: Felix Otto, Tim Pawlowski, and Christian Deutscher

PRESENTATIONS (FROM RECENT YEARS ONLY)

2026	VfS Annual Conference (Innsbruck); 17th ESEA Conference on Sport Economics (Zurich); 3rd Workshop on Sports, Economics, and Natural Experiments (Stirling); 15th Sport Economics Symposium (Innsbruck)
2025	THE Workshop (Hohenheim); 27th German Sport Science Conference (Münster); 16th ESEA Conference on Sport Economics (Innsbruck); The Behavioral Workshop (Ulm); 28th Annual Meeting of the German Association of Sport Economics and Sport Management (Koblenz)
2024	Workshop on Sports, Economics, and Natural Experiments (Zurich); Workshop on Fairness in Sports (Ghent)

TEACHING

Institute of Sports Science, University of Tübingen

Master level (M.Sc. Sport Management)

- 2021–2026 **Empirical Research Seminar (Sport Management Research)**, project seminar
- 2020–2026 **Applied Sport Management**, project seminar; including supervision of student teams in the International Olympic Case Study Competition
- 2020–2022 **Sport Media and Communication: Sport Media Reception and Digitalization**, seminar

Bachelor level (B.Sc. Sports Science, profile Sport Management)

- 2023/24 **Introduction to Working and Study Techniques**, seminar
- 2020–2021 **Conception, Organisation and Evaluation of Sports**, seminar; International Sport Management Game in collaboration with Hanze University of Applied Sciences Groningen
- 2018–2020 **Behavioral Sports Economics**, seminar
- 2017–2020 **Sport Sponsorship-Linked Marketing**, seminar

Supervision

- 14 Master's theses (M.Sc. Sport Management, M.Ed. Economics)
- 19 Bachelor's theses (B.Sc. Sport Management)

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Refereeing Activities

Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics, The American Statistician, International Review of Economics, Journal of Sports Economics, Sports Economics Review, European Sport Management Quarterly, International Journal of Sport Finance, International Journal of Sports Marketing and Sponsorship, International Journal of Sport Policy and Politics

Other

- Invited speaker at the Studium Generale “Sports Cultures, Performance, and Diversity” (Center for Gender and Diversity Research, Institute of Sports Science, University of Tübingen, 2026)
- Organizer, Workshop on Integrity in Sport, Frankfurt, 2024
- Contributor, Berlin Replication Game, Institute for Replication, 2025
- Member, European Sport Economics Association (ESEA)

MEDIA COVERAGE (SELECTION)

- *The Economist*: “How to detect nationalism in winter-sport judges” (2022)
- *Le Devoir*: “Critique de la faculté de juger aux Jeux olympiques”, interview (2022)
- *The Weekly Sports Piece* podcast: interview and paper discussion (2022)
- *Der Spiegel*: “Ein primitiver menschlicher Instinkt” (2020)